Bussin Easy Guide

This guide is short on purpose. Each part is one job, a few steps, and a picture. You do not need to read it all. Find your job, do the steps, and stop.

Start here

The 3 golden rules

1. **Red means do something. Green means relax.** That is most of the job.
2. **You cannot break it by looking.** Clicking around to look is safe. The only button that erases things is the pink **Danger zone** box, and it asks you to type a word first.
3. **Stuck? Stop and call.** Do not keep clicking. Call your IT support. That is what they are there for.

Find your job, then skip to it

I am...	Read these parts	Time
Working in the **office**	Signing in, then Office parts 1 to 4	15 minutes
Setting up Bussin for the first time	Office part 5 (setup cards)	30 minutes, once
Driving a bus	Signing in, then Driver	5 minutes
A **parent**	Signing in, then Parent	3 minutes

Words you will see

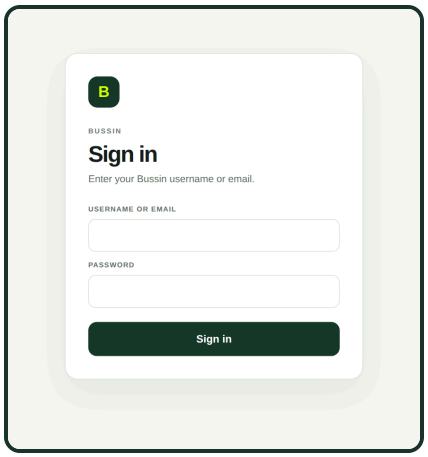
Just these. Nothing else.

Word	What it means
Click	Press the left mouse button once. On a phone, tap with your finger.
Double-click	Press it twice, fast, like a knock-knock.
Button	A box with words in it that does something when you click it, like **Plan trip**.
Menu	The list of words down the left side of the screen. Click a word to go there.
Box or **drop-down**	A white box you type in, or click to pick from a list.
Scroll	Roll the mouse wheel, or slide your finger up on a phone, to see more.
Trip	One bus driving one route at one time. "Bus 1, Maplewood North, 7:45 AM."
Route	The list of stops a bus drives, in order.

In this guide, a word in **bold** is written exactly as it looks on your screen. Look for it, then click it.

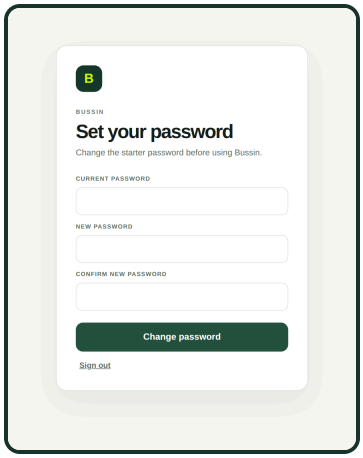
Signing in (everyone)

You need: the Bussin web address, your username or email, and the password the office gave you. **Takes:** 2 minutes.



- [ ] Type your **username** or **email** in the top box.
- [ ] Type your **password** in the second box.
- [ ] Click **Sign in**.

The very first time only, you will see this screen instead:



- [ ] Top box: type the password the office gave you.

- [ ] Middle box: make up a new password. It must be **12 letters or longer**. A short sentence is easiest, like `blue bus at nine`.
- [ ] Bottom box: type the new password again, exactly the same.
- [ ] Click **Change password**.
- [ ] You land back on **Sign in**. This is normal. Sign in with your **new** password.

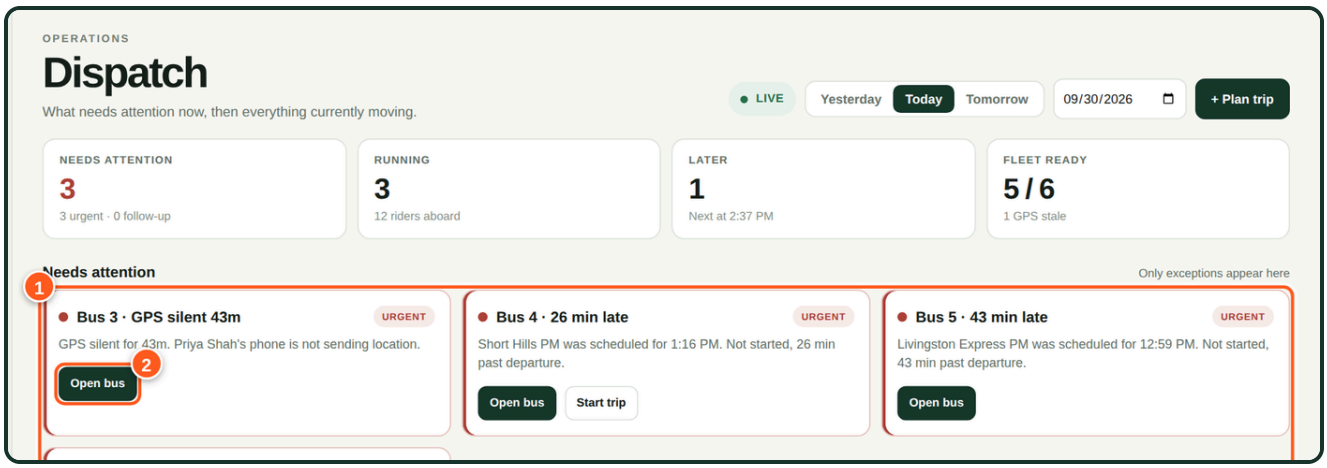
Done when: you see your Bussin screen.

Write your new password down and keep it somewhere safe.

Office part 1: your main screen

Your main screen is called **Dispatch**. It is the first thing you see after signing in. **Leave it open all day.** It updates by itself, so you never need to refresh.

You only need to look at one place: the **Needs attention** row.



1. **Red boxes** = something needs you. Each one says what is wrong in plain words.
2. **The dark button inside it** takes you straight to the fix. Click it.

If there are no red boxes, you will see a green box that says **Nothing needs you**. That means everything is fine. Go get a coffee.

What the red boxes usually mean

The box says	Do this
GPS silent	The driver's phone went to sleep. **Call the driver.** Ask them to open Bussin and tap **Keep screen on**.
... min late	The bus has not started. **Call the driver.**
No driver	Nobody is driving this trip. See Office part 3.
Ride Check decisions	Click **Resolve in Ride Check**. See Office part 4.

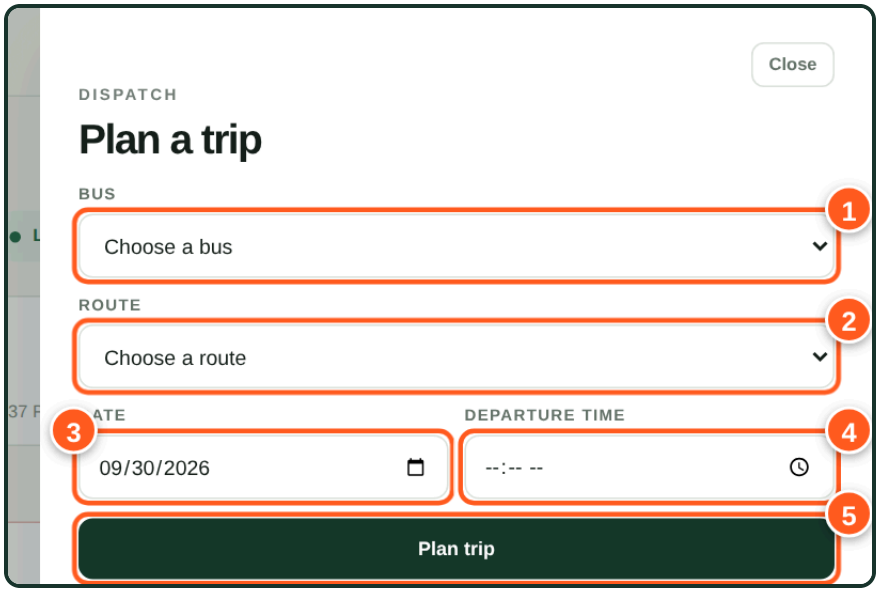
The map and the list of buses under it are there if you want them. You can ignore them.

Office part 2: plan a bus trip

You need: which bus, which route, what day, what time. **Takes:** 1 minute per trip.

- [ ] On **Dispatch**, click the dark **+ Plan trip** button (top right corner).

A panel slides in from the right:



- [ ] **1.** Click the **Bus** box. Pick a bus from the list.
- [ ] **2.** Click the **Route** box. Pick a route from the list.
- [ ] **3.** Check the **Date**. It starts on today. Click it to pick another day.
- [ ] **4.** Click the **Departure time** box. Type the time as 4 numbers, like `0745`, then type `A` for morning or `P` for afternoon.
- [ ] **5.** Click **Plan trip**.

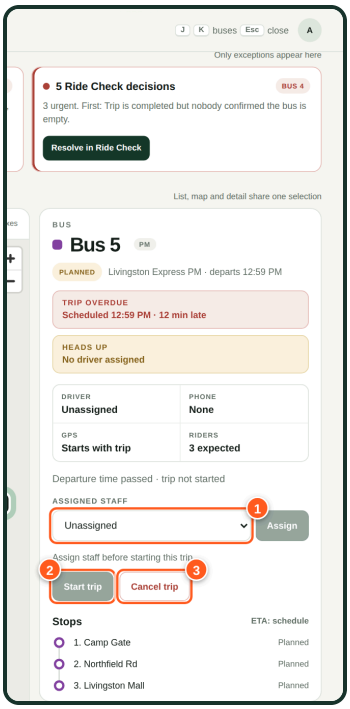
Done when: a note says the trip was planned.

Made a mistake? Click **Close** at the top of the panel, or press the **Esc** key on your keyboard. Nothing is saved until you click **Plan trip**.

Office part 3: pick who drives

A trip cannot start until someone is picked to drive it. **Takes:** 30 seconds.

- [ ] On **Dispatch**, scroll down to the list called **Today's buses**.
- [ ] Click the trip. Its details open on the right side.



- [ ] **1.** Click the box under **Assigned staff**. Pick the person's name. Then click **Assign** right next to it.

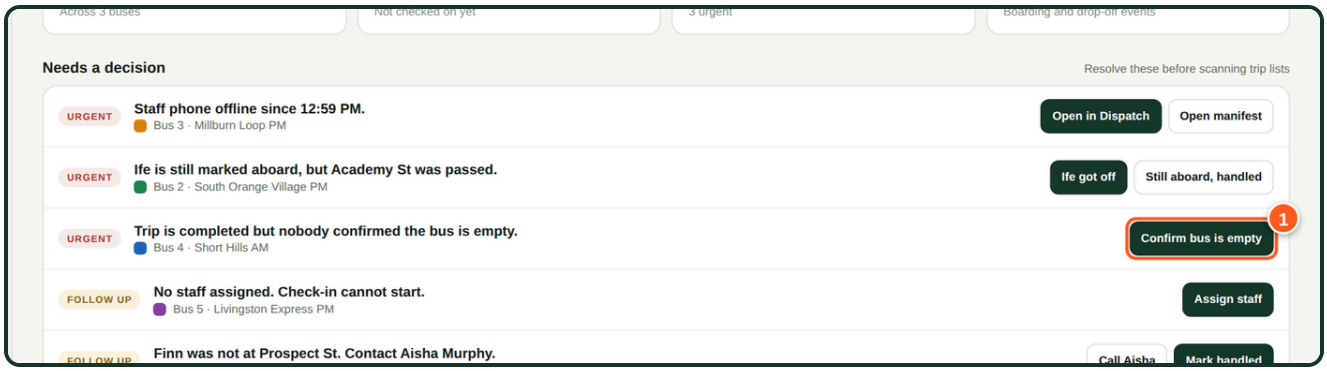
Done when: their name shows where it said **Unassigned**. The trip now shows up on their phone by itself.

Leave the other two buttons alone. The driver presses **Start trip** (2) from their own phone. **Cancel trip** (3) cannot be undone.

Office part 4: make sure every child got off

After each run, check that no child was left on a bus. **Takes:** 1 minute.

- [ ] In the menu on the left, click **Ride Check**.
- [ ] Look at the list called **Needs a decision**. Every line is one problem, with its fix button on the right.



- [ ] Read each line. Click the button that matches what really happened. Example: the line says a trip is done but nobody checked the bus, so the driver checks the bus, then you click **Confirm bus is empty** (1).
- [ ] Not sure? **Call the driver** before you click anything.

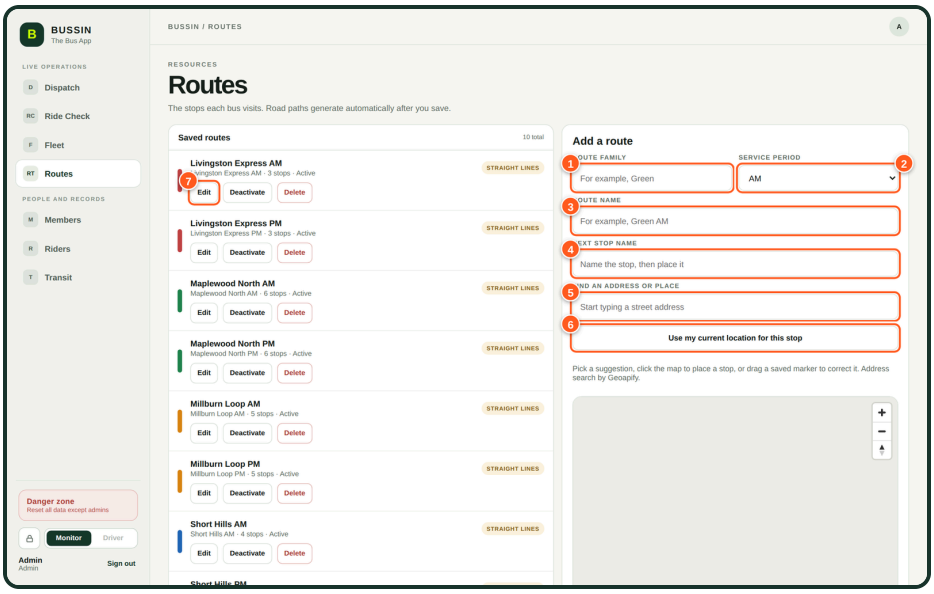
Done when: the list says **Everyone is accounted for**.

Office part 5: one-time setup

You do this once, at the start. **Do the cards in this order**, A to F. Each one needs the one before it. Take a break between cards if you want; nothing is lost.

Card A: add a route (the hardest one; ask for help the first time)

Takes: 10 minutes per route.



- [ ] Click **Routes** in the menu on the left.
- [ ] **1.** Type the route's short name, like `Green`.
- [ ] **2.** Pick **AM** (morning) or **PM** (afternoon).
- [ ] **3.** Type the full name, like `Green AM`.
- [ ] **4.** Type the name of the first stop, like `Oak St & Elm`.
- [ ] **5.** Type its street address. Click the right one when it pops up. Then click **Add stop at this pin**.
- [ ] Do steps 4 and 5 again for every stop, **in the order the bus drives them**.
- [ ] Scroll down and click **Save route**.

Morning and afternoon are separate routes. Make one of each.

Card B: add a bus

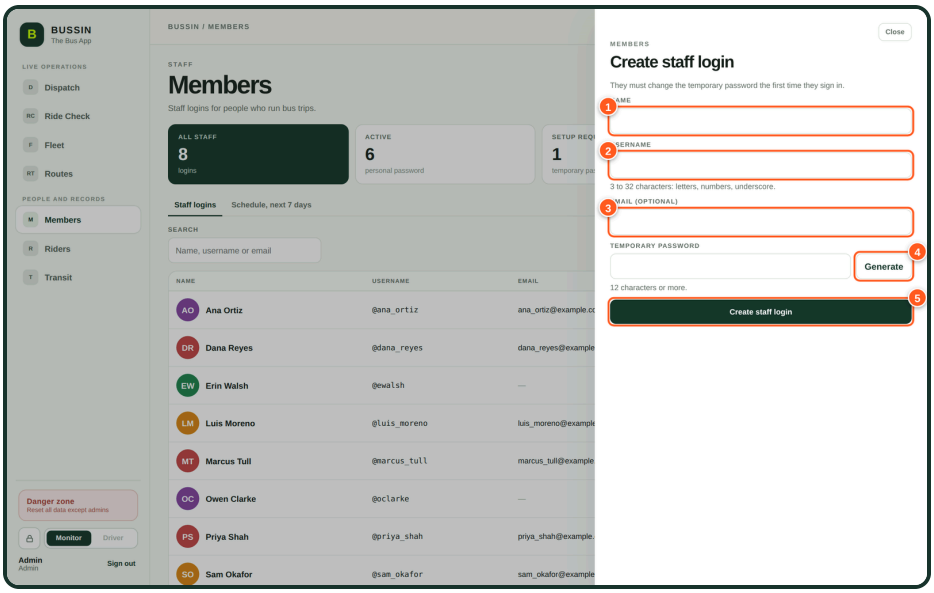
Takes: 30 seconds.



- [ ] Click **Fleet** in the menu, then the dark **Add bus** button.
- [ ] **1.** Type the bus name, like `Bus 7`.
- [ ] **2.** Click **Add bus**.

Card C: add a driver

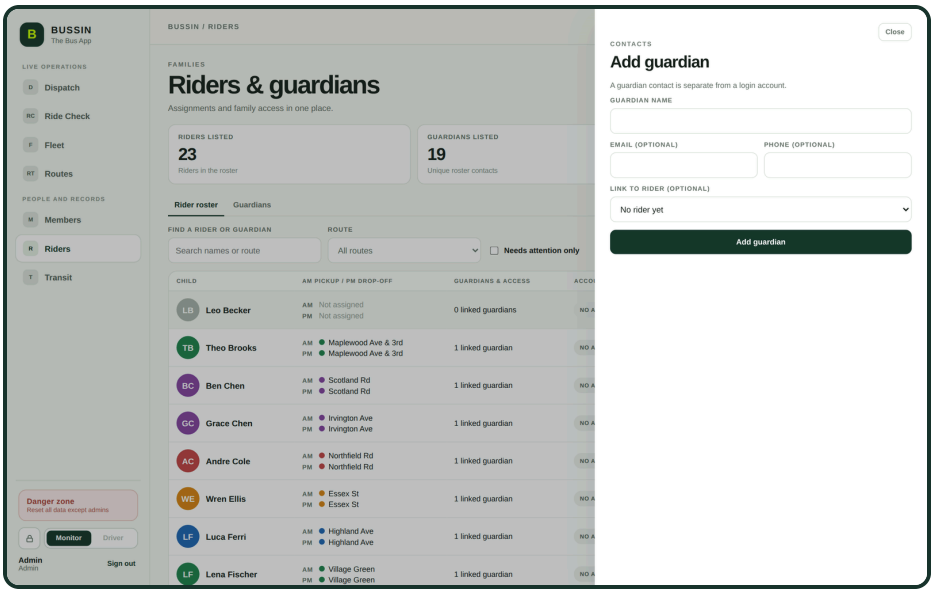
Takes: 1 minute per person.



- [ ] Click **Members** in the menu, then **Add staff login**.
- [ ] **1.** Their full name.
- [ ] **2.** A username they will type, like `dana_reyes`. Letters, numbers and _ only.
- [ ] **3.** Their email (you can skip this).
- [ ] **4.** Click **Generate**. It makes a password for you.
- [ ] **5.** Click **Create staff login**.
- [ ] **Write down the username and password** it shows in green. Give them to the driver.

Card D: add a parent

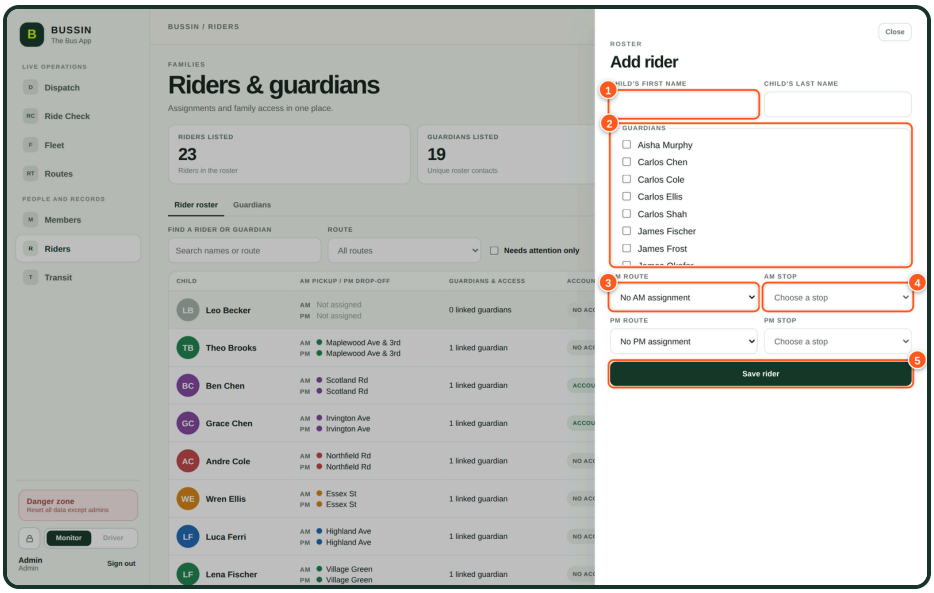
Takes: 1 minute per parent. **Always do the parent before the child.**



- [ ] Click **Riders** in the menu, then **Add guardian**.
- [ ] Type their name, email and phone.
- [ ] Click **Add guardian**.

Card E: add a child

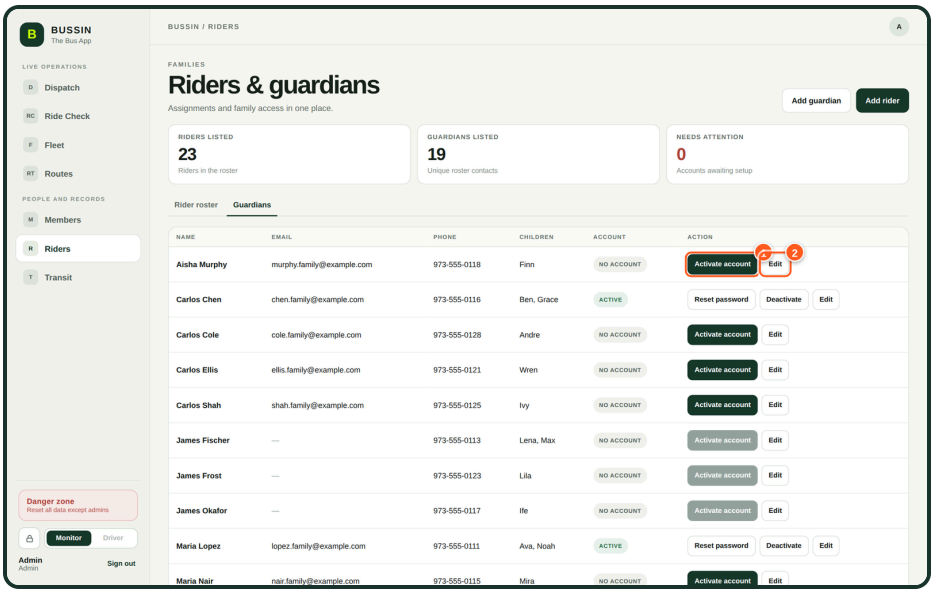
Takes: 1 minute per child.



- [ ] Click **Riders** in the menu, then **Add rider**.
- [ ] **1.** Type the child's first and last name.
- [ ] **2.** Tick the box next to their parent's name.
- [ ] **3** and **4.** Pick their morning route and stop. Then their afternoon route and stop.
- [ ] **5.** Click **Save rider**.

Card F: give a parent the app

Takes: 30 seconds per parent.



- [ ] On **Riders**, click the word **Guardians** near the top.
- [ ] **1.** Find the parent. Click **Activate account**.
- [ ] **Write down the password** it shows in green at the top. It only shows once.
- [ ] Give the parent: the Bussin web address, their email, and that password.

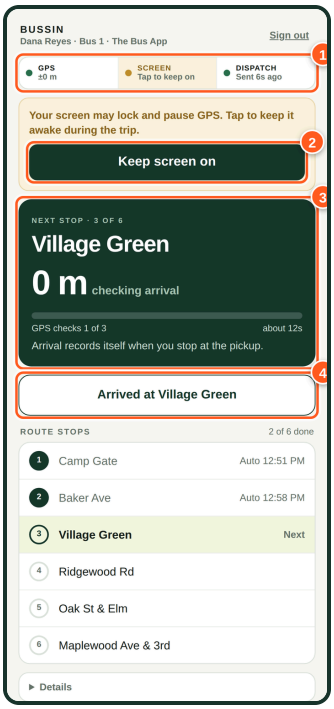
Driver: your trip in 4 taps

The phone does almost everything. Your only real job: **keep Bussin open on the screen the whole trip.**

The first time only:

- [ ] Open the Bussin web address on your phone and sign in (see Signing in).
- [ ] When the phone asks to use your location, tap **Allow**.

Every trip:



- [ ] **Tap 1:** When your trip shows up, tap **Start trip**.
- [ ] **Tap 2:** Tap **Keep screen on** (2 in the picture). This stops the phone from falling asleep.
- [ ] **Drive.** The big box (3) shows your next stop. When you stop there, the phone notices by itself. You do not need to tap anything.

- [ ] **Tap 3 (only if needed):** if the phone did not notice a stop, tap **Arrived at …** (4).
- [ ] **Tap 4:** At the last stop, walk the bus to make sure it is empty. Then tap **Finish trip**.

Done when: the phone says **Nice work.**

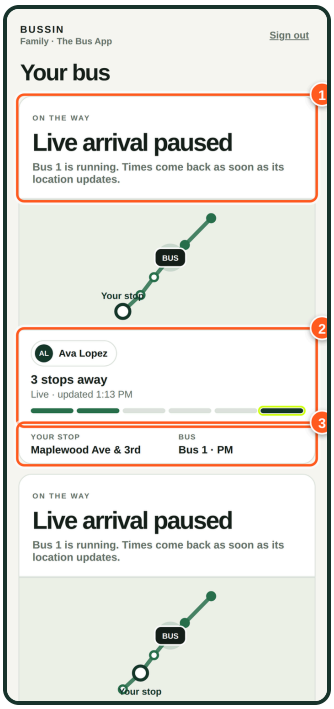
Leave the phone on the dash with Bussin open. Do not close it, and do not switch to other apps while driving.

The phone says	Do this
Nothing assigned	Wait. Your trip will show up by itself.
Location is turned off	Pull over. Open the phone's Settings, turn Location on, come back, tap **Try again**.
GPS stopped updating	Tap **Restart GPS**.
Offline	Nothing. Keep driving. It catches up when signal returns.

Parent: knowing when to walk to the stop

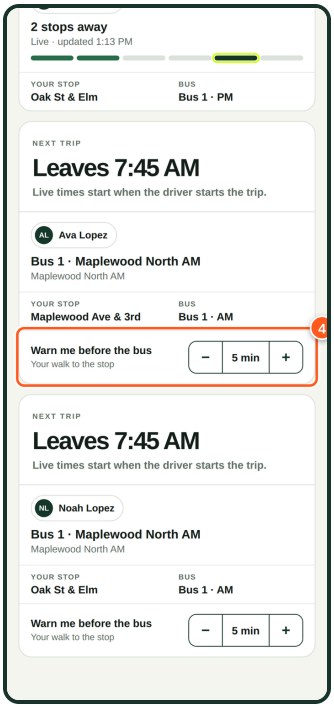
You need: the Bussin web address, your email, and the password the office gave you.

- [ ] Sign in on your phone (see Signing in). Use your **email**.
- [ ] You now see **Your bus**. That's it. It updates by itself.



1. **The big words at the top** tell you what to do right now. When it says **LEAVE NOW**, walk out the door.
2. Your child's name, and **how many stops away** the bus is.
3. Your stop, and which bus.

One setting worth doing (mornings):



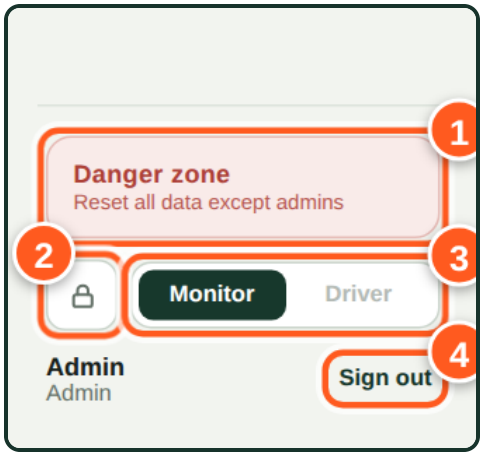
- [ ] Find **Warn me before the bus**. Tap **+** or **−** until it shows how many minutes it takes you to walk to the stop.

Now Bussin counts down and tells you when to leave home.

Tip: in your phone's browser, tap **Share**, then **Add to Home Screen**. Bussin then opens from an icon, like any app.

Never press these

They live in the bottom left corner of the office screen.



1. **The pink Danger zone box.** It erases everything: buses, routes, children, parents, drivers. There is no undo. If you open it by accident, click **Cancel**.
2. **The little lock** (2) **and Monitor / Driver** (3). Leave these alone. If the menu suddenly says **My Bus** instead of **Ride Check**, see Stuck below.
3. **Sign out** (4) is fine to press when you leave the computer.

Stuck?

First: stop clicking. Take a breath. Then find what you see below.

What is happening	Do this
A panel is open and I want out	Click **Close** at its top right, or press the **Esc** key.
I changed my password and it sent me back to Sign in	That is normal. Sign in with the new password.
It says too many sign-in attempts	Wait the minutes it says. Then type slowly.
A parent forgot their password	**Riders** → **Guardians** → find them → **Reset password**. Give them the new one.
The Bus or Route box in Plan a trip is empty	Setup is not finished. Do Card A and Card B.
The menu says **My Bus** instead of **Ride Check**	Double-click the little lock (bottom left). Click **Monitor**.
The screen says **Connection unavailable**	Check the internet. Then click **Retry**.
Anything else	**Call your IT support.** 24/7, same-day fixes, no tickets, no hold times.

Write your IT support number here so you always have it: ____